



Disha

Voluntary organization of IISER Pune students

Constitution

I. Vision:

1. Creating a sustainable environment which will provide equal opportunities for all towards holistic development
2. Creating a culture of “thinking beyond self” among the youth

II. Mission:

1. Removing education inequity by providing necessary forms of education to the underserved children through voluntary work
2. Inspiring children to become self-dependent
3. Creating a force of youth who are proactive towards bringing about social change

III. Goals:

[Time bound for one year]

1. Developing database of activities for Disha
2. Developing relationship with parents of students at abhyasikas
3. Organizing one training workshop for volunteers/members per semester
4. Conducting annual Disha day with focus on the following
 - Exhibition of activities (in the form of posters)
 - Fund raising
 - Meeting with advisory committee
 - General meeting

IV. Organizational structure:

1. Hierarchical Structure

(1) Core team

➤ Consists of -

❖ General coordinator:

- Represents the overall involvement and final responsibility of the organization
- Explores new initiatives to drive the organization towards the vision
- Calls and presides over core team meetings and general meetings



- Maintains close communication and collaboration with advisory committee
- ❖ **Abhyasika coordinator:**
 - Represents final responsibility of the abhyasikas
 - Maintains communication with coordinators of all the abhyasikas
 - Volunteer management across abhyasikas
 - Forming a bridge between resource team and abhyasikas regarding development and implementation of new activities
- ❖ **Outreach coordinator:**
 - Design and planning of activities of Outreach team
 - Responsible for press and out-campus publicity
- ❖ **Resource coordinator:**
 - Coordination of activities of Resource team in accordance with the needs of the organization
 - Maintaining treasury
 - Responsible for in-campus publicity of Disha activities
- ❖ **Deputy general coordinator:**
 - Appointed by General coordinator from amongst the other three core team members (Abhyasika, Outreach, Resource coordinators)
 - Represents the General coordinator in his/her absence by performing all his/her duties
 - Calls and presides over coordinator meetings
 - Maintains close communication with activity coordinators
- **Selection procedure**
 - ❖ Eligibility: coordinator of an activity for at least one semester
 - ❖ Nomination: self-nomination, nomination by coordinators (in order of preference)
 - ❖ Consensus (or voting if needed) by present - past coordinators and past core team
 - ❖ The core team will decide the General coordinator in consultation with the past core team
- **Guidelines**
 - ❖ All core team members have to be members of one of the Disha activities.
 - ❖ Term of core team members: minimum 1 year, maximum 2 years



- ❖ All decisions in core team are to be taken by consensus. If there is need for voting, General coordinator will have the casting vote.

(2) Activity Coordinators

- Role
 - ❖ Head of the group of members for the respective activity
 - ❖ Encouraging participation of new volunteers and observing their transition towards becoming members
 - ❖ Single point of contact with respect to the activity, both at the working site and in the organization
 - ❖ Calling meetings of the members where decisions are made collectively
 - ❖ Writing monthly report and submitting it to the Resource coordinator
- Selection procedure
 - ❖ Eligibility: 2 semester experience as a member
 - ❖ Consensus/ voting: Previous coordinators along with the member group in presence of the core team
- Guidelines
 - ❖ Will depute someone from members in case of absence
 - ❖ New appointment of activity coordinator every spring semester

(3) Members

- Role
 - ❖ Assisting the respective coordinator in planning and execution of activities
 - ❖ Being regular and responsible for the task assigned to them
- Selection procedure
 - ❖ Eligibility: Volunteering for 10 (or number fixed by the respective activity coordinator) sessions in a Disha activity followed by conducting one full session individually (reviewed by the coordinator)
- Guidelines:
 - ❖ Sharing of responsibilities with the coordinator on a regular basis and especially during an event of importance

(4) Volunteers

- ❖ Disha is open to participation for everyone as a volunteer in all the activities, in coordination with the members



2. Meetings:

(1) Members

- Participants: members of a particular activity
- Frequency: weekly (or at most biweekly)
- Agenda
 - ❖ Review and planning of activities
 - ❖ Discussion regarding any other issue e.g. relevant work of any social organization, viewing of documentary etc.

(2) Abhyasika coordinators

- Participants: Abhyasika coordinator, coordinators of individual abhyasikas and Resource coordinator
- Frequency: biweekly
- Agenda
 - ❖ Sharing of ideas being implemented at various abhyasikas
 - ❖ Listing of expectations from Resource team in terms of activities and Materials

(3) Coordinator meeting

- Participants: All coordinators + anyone interested
- Frequency: monthly
- Agenda
 - ❖ Presentation/talk on social issues by one of the coordinators/ invited guest

(4) Core team meeting

- Participants: core team members
- Frequency: biweekly
- Agenda
 - ❖ Review of ongoing activities
 - ❖ Exploration of new horizons for Disha

(5) General meeting

- Participants: All members and anyone interested
- Date: 15th August and 26th January (once a semester)
- Agenda



- ❖ Presentation of progress during previous semester and plan for the coming semester
- ❖ Inspirational talk/video

(6) Advisory committee meeting

- Participants: Advisory committee, core team and coordinators
- Date: 26th January - Disha day
- Agenda
 - ❖ Presentation of progress during previous semester and plan for the coming semester
 - ❖ Seeking advice from the advisory committee

3. Advisory committee:

- Advisory committee will consist of people with experience of working in areas such as education, livelihood generation, healthcare and other social or organizational activities.
- Role:
 - ❖ Attending advisory committee meeting on Disha day (26th January)
 - ❖ Providing advice to Disha coordinators during the meeting and in other times of need

V. Activities:

1. Regular Activities

(1) Lamanvasti Abhyasika:

- Aim: To make children curious about science by supplementing their school studies through activities
- Goals:
 - To increase their concentration span by increasing working hours
 - To systematically cover all topics and activities in the school syllabus
 - To organise a weekend program for selected students at IISER
- Guidelines:
 - Coordinator should select a team every week who will take responsibility for the weekend program.



- Coordinator should keep track of how much of the syllabus has been covered and how much has to be covered in a given week.

(2) Construction site Abhyasika :

- Aim : To provide basic education to non-school-going children of construction workers near IISER Pune campus
- Goals :
 - Mentoring and assessment of individual students (based on targets specified by members)
 - To encourage girls to learn by starting special Saturday and Sunday classes
- Guidelines:
 - Developing innovative ideas for teaching by communicating with other organisations working in similar areas.

(3) Someshwarwadi Abhyasika :

- Aims :
 - To provide basic Arithmetic and English education for school children
 - To provide self-employment education to girls
- Goals :
 - To organize an exhibition cum sale of the things made by the girls
 - To make sure every child can read at least one full book in English
 - To make sure every child knows basic arithmetic and those who already do learn fractions and decimals
- Guidelines :
 - Have a regular schedule for teaching members.
 - Try to include as many activities as possible.
 - Try to strengthen the relationship between the parents, members and coordinators. (This will increase the number of children attending the Abhyasika).
 - The girls of the self-employment program will be preferred if of the age group 11-16.

(4) Outreach team:

- Aims:
 - Reaching out to villages around Pune focusing mainly on improvising education and using science and technology to solve their daily-life problems.
 - To involve students from other institutes in the activities.



➤ Goals:

- Trying to find solutions to the problems identified during Spread the Smile '12 and '13 through small village-based projects
- Organizing continuous school-based activity at the villages in the form of providing educational material and career counseling
- Organizing a camp of extraordinary students, from Spread the Smile schools, at IISER Pune to provide better exposure to them

➤ Guidelines:

The team should keep in mind that we cannot expect to bring drastic changes in a particular place given the time and people we have, but we can make people of the villages aware about many issues and hope that someday they themselves may understand the problems to think of a solution.

(5) Resource team:

➤ Aims:

- Maintaining and development of collective knowledge and activities database
- To organize some in-campus activities to create a social-conscious environment and to gather support (both voluntary and financial) in favor of Disha.
- Maintaining records of treasury of Disha

➤ Goals:

- To build a good team (with a sustainable structure) of creative persons that will include members of other activities.
- Identifying sources (on internet, books and other collaborating organizations) of activity design and various other pedagogical documents in accordance with the needs of Disha activities.
- To manage online publicity through an active Facebook-page and the Blog and to explore the possibilities of a website.

➤ Guidelines:

- The Resource team will be divided into sub-teams having specific tasks (e.g. publicity and database, treasury, resource development, in-campus activities).
- All Resource team activities will be done maintaining good communication with other Disha activities and responding to the requirements of the organization.



2. Flagship activities:

(1) Spread the Smile:

- Aims:
 - Spreading the “joy” of education in rural schools.
 - Providing “exposure” towards different aspects of education with focus on science and technology.
 - Inculcating “inspiration” amongst volunteers towards understanding and implementing their novel ideas directed towards social change
- Guidelines:
 - Choice of rural schools- located in remote areas, not equipped enough with educational facilities
 - Activities should cover a wide spectrum across the field of education (breadth preferred over depth).
 - Volunteer participation should be encouraged from larger section of the society including other colleges and organizations.

(2) Jigyasa:

- Aims:
 - Science camp in Pune for students from remote (preferably tribal) areas in India
 - Motto - “Excite, expose and inspire”
- Guidelines:
 - Collaborative work with different institutions and organizations

VI. Other guidelines

1. Funding

- Funding should be accepted only from socially conscious individuals and not from any other organizations or corporate/ government agencies
- The amount of funds accepted should be in accordance with the needs of the activities during the particular year
- The use of funds should be done only for activities of Disha and not for personal purposes
- Any decision regarding funds will be taken by the core team

2. Amendments

- Amendments to the constitution can be suggested only by the coordinators.
- The core team will discuss the amendments and put forward the amendment for voting in a ‘special meeting’ of coordinators called and presided by the General coordinator.
- An amendment can be passed only with more than $\frac{3}{4}$ th majority.